

Session 3: Delivering the Deliverer

Key Takeaways

- Moses' deliverance in the reeds anticipates Israel's deliverance through the Sea of Reeds.
- Moses' deliverance through the waters of the Nile echoes Noah's deliverance through the waters of the flood.
- Seeing things the way God sees them, as the key women in this narrative do, is a first step toward trusting God and acting the way he does.

A Tale of Three Daughters

In chapter 2, three daughters introduce a theme of "seeing" that connects back to Genesis and carries on throughout Exodus.

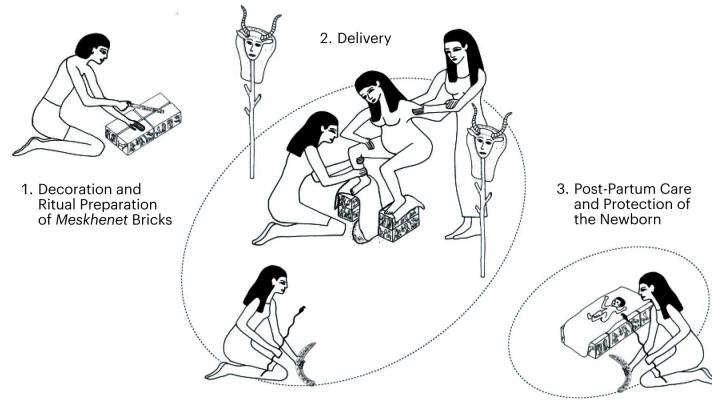
- The daughter of Levi "saw that he was good" (Exod. 2:2).
- The baby's sister "stood at a distance to see what would happen to/for him" (Exod. 2:4).
- The daughter of Pharaoh "saw the basket ... saw the baby ... and felt sorry for him" (Exod. 2:5-6).

Language of seeing punctuates the following chapters as God looks on the Israelites in compassion (Exod. 2:25), sees their misery and suffering (Exod. 3:7), and sees the way the Egyptians are oppressing them (Exod. 3:9).

Delivery Stool or Birthing Bricks?

In Exodus 1:16, the word *abnayim* translates to "two stones." This term has been interpreted several ways. It could refer to:

- Birthing equipment: See Jeremiah 18:3 (potter's wheel)
- Genitalia: This would be the only such occurrence
- Birthing stool: Possible, but Pharaoh's instruction in verse 16 would be strange
- Ritual bricks: See Josef Wegner, "[Tradition and Innovation: The Middle Kingdom](#)" on birthing bricks used as a stool and then rearranged for a newborn ritual



Reconstruction of the Practice of Childbirth During the Late Middle Kingdom. Wegner, Josef (2010). Tradition and Innovation: The Middle Kingdom. Academia.edu.

Women Delivering the Deliverer

Midwife, mother, sister, daughter, wife—each woman courageously defies Pharaoh by working within her sphere of influence to resist injustice.

- Shiphrah and Puah (the midwives)
- The boy's mother
- The boy's sister
- The daughter of Pharaoh
- The maidservants of Pharaoh's daughter
- Zipporah ([chapter 4](#))

Pharaoh had "let the girls live" (Heb. *hayah*; [Exod. 1:16, 22](#)) but women became his greatest threat. Their "liveliness" (Heb. *hayeh*) was the reason they kept bearing sons ([Exod. 1:19](#)).

Reflection Question

Reflect on the compassion of Pharaoh's daughter in Exodus 2:5-6 and compare it to the description of Yahweh's compassion in [Exodus 2:25](#). How does this illustrate the possibility of human participation in God's work?